



SYSTEM / SECURITY

4624

SuccessfulLogon

4625

Failed Logon

7036

Service Started

1102

AuditLog Cleared

4688

Process Created

4720

UserAccountCreated

Windows Event Logging

A Beginner's Guide to Windows Auditing & Digital Forensics

The Control Room

Registry & Storage

🔍 THE BRAIN

Registry

`HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\...EventLog`

MaxSize — controls max log file size

File — specifies where to save logs

Overflow policy — overwrite old data or stop recording

📁 THE CABINET

Log Files (.evtx)

`C:\Windows\System32\winevt\Logs`

All event logs are stored here as .evtx files. You can copy these to another machine for offline analysis — a key technique in Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR).

The Logbooks

Main Log Categories

System

Hardware & OS book. Tracks driver installs, Windows updates, power supply failures.

Security

Mother of All Logs. Tracks who logged in/out. Silent by default — enable Audit Policies first.

Application

Software book. App crashes, antivirus blocks, and program events land here.

Setup

Specifically for Windows installations and major OS updates.

Forwarded

Enterprise use: one master computer collects logs from all machines on the network.

The Urgency Level

Event Types — What the Level field tells you



Everything is fine — just a status update that a task started or completed.



Something unusual detected. Not broken yet, but keep an eye on it.



Something failed. A service didn't start or an application crashed.



A user tried to access something and was allowed. (Security log only)



A user tried to access something and was blocked. (Security log only)

Reading the Entry

Metadata Inside Every Log Event

EventID	4624 Unique number code per event type. Pros Google these instantly for context.
Source	Service Control Manager Which program or sub-system generated the log entry.
User	DOMAIN\jshmith Which user account was active when the event occurred.
Logged	2024-06-01 14:32:07 Exact date & time — vital for building a forensic attack timeline.
Category	Logon A label grouping similar events together for easier filtering.